

NEW LIFELINES A section of the newly inaugurated Dwarka Expressway and the Urban Extension Road-II in New Delhi, Aug. 17

ANI

for farmers remains overwhelming at 75.5 per cent, even as it has declined from February's 86.6 per cent. This suggests growing awareness of fiscal constraints amid continuing sympathy for agricultural distress.

Another significant verdict lies in perceptions of social harmony and safety. On communal relations, only a thin majority thinks conditions have improved under the NDA. Almost as many say they have worsened, and among those who see deterioration, nearly one in four directly blame the BJP-RSS.

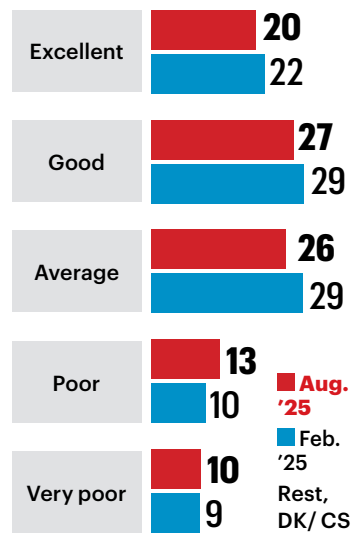
Pockets of Optimism

And yet, there are signs of optimism. For instance, the recognition of the government's infrastructure push, with nearly 50 per cent satisfied with the road quality. Amid growing global concerns around climate change, Indians seem to be driven by a self-assured complacency. More than half the respondents think the country is doing enough to protect the environment.

The biggest endorsement, though, came for the judiciary, often seen as democracy's last line of defence. A combined 71 per cent of respondents say they trust the judicial system either 'a great deal' or 'somewhat'. Yet the fact that nearly 59 per cent respondents don't fully trust the courts reflects growing frustration with delayed justice and perceived politicisation of the institution.

The poll reveals an electorate not rejecting the system but renegotiating its terms with it. India remains a country of sweeping mandates and grand promises, yet citizens are no longer content to cheer from the sidelines. They are less inclined to overlook failures as the inevitable cost of ambition. Voters still endorse structural reforms, value strong leadership and take pride in their democratic freedoms, but they now demand vision coupled with fairness and bold ideas matched by honest execution. ■

Q. How would you rate the quality of roads and infrastructure development in India?



Nearly 50% of the respondents are satisfied with the road quality

All figures in % and rounded off